

In chapter 2, you learned about Django apps: the modules that Django uses to group code components together. The RiffMates project has multiple apps inside, organizing your code. These kinds of apps can also be packaged separately from a project and distributed on their own. Like other Python libraries, they are available on PyPI and installable through `pip`.

NOTE Building installable apps is beyond the scope of this book. You can see my article “How to Write an Installable Django App” (<https://realpython.com/installable-django-app/>) for more details though.

Part 3 of this book covers a number of third-party libraries, each with its own installation requirements. This section covers the installation of the Django Debug Toolbar in detail as an example of how third-party libraries get installed.

First and foremost, when dealing with a third-party library, RTFM (read that funky manual)! I know, reading is hard, but each library has its own needs. The Django Debug Toolbar is a relatively complicated install, and it serves as a decent example. The toolbar’s docs are available at: <https://django-debug-toolbar.readthedocs.io/en/latest/index.html>.

As the name implies, the Django Debug Toolbar is a developer’s tool to help you debug your application. It works as an overlay inside the browser, allowing you to inspect the details of any page you are viewing. How to use the toolbar gets covered in chapter 13.

Third-party Django apps get packaged like any other Python package, so installation starts through the use of the `pip` command. Don’t forget to be inside your virtual environment:

```
(venv) RiffMates$ python -m pip install django-debug-toolbar
```

Most, but not all, Django third-party libraries name themselves with a *django-* prefix. Likewise, most, but not all, use dashes between the words of their names. Be careful when installing any Python package, as nefarious people sometimes upload bad things to PyPI with names similar to popular packages. The awesome folks at PyPI do a great job of finding and removing evil packages, but it is good to be mindful.

Once you have a package installed in your virtual environment, it is time to tell your Django project about it. Almost all Django third-party libraries are Django apps, so they need to be added to the `INSTALLED_APPS` configuration value in `settings.py`:

```
# RiffMates/RiffMates/settings.py
...
INSTALLED_APPS = [
    "django.contrib.admin",
    "django.contrib.auth",
    ...
    "home",
    "bands",
    ...
    "debug_toolbar",
]
```

Add the Django Debug Toolbar’s module name to register its app